The Price of Loyalty

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/62435173.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warnings:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings, No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
M/M

Fandom:
崩坏：星穹铁道 | Honkai: Star Rail (Video Game)

Relationship:
Mydei/Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)

Characters:
Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Tribbie (Honkai: Star Rail)

Additional Tags:
Protective Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Hurt Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Self-Indulgent, injuries, Fluff, Betrayal, Panic

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2025-01-23 Words: 3,629 Chapters: 1/1

The Price of Loyalty

by Lunaeryi

Summary

> Mydei didn’t move. He didn’t rush to Phainon’s side. He remained where he stood, eerily calm—silent, still. His gaze was steady, unwavering, as if the chaos of the situation didn’t touch him at all. There was no anger in his expression, no frustration, just the same unreadable calm Phainon had seen in him before. But this time, it was different. It wasn’t the usual coldness. It was something far more unsettling.
>
> “Who did this to you?”

OR in which Phainon gets hurts, Mydei is chill about it and gets Phainon to Okhema, and then proceeds to lose his shit off-screen.

Notes

> HELP MY DUMBASS FORGOT TO TAG THE RELATIONSHIP FOR AN HOUR😭
>
> I was planning on not posting for like a year, but these 2 have my heart in their grip, so I conceded and wrote this. Plus the comments on my previous fic genuinely made my day when I felt depressed so
>
> I’m 50% sure this has grammar or format errors so please tell me if you spot them, I’d rather you guys have the full fanfic experience rather than witness my mistakes :’)

See the end of the work for more notes

The world spun, the pain amplifying with each shallow breath, each beat of his heart that grew weaker. Phainon's vision faded in and out, but his mind lingered on that final question. The poison had done its work—he was fading. He couldn't fight it anymore. Not this time. Not with this betrayal weighing on him.

He would never make it to Okhema.

what was slipping away.

His heart hammered against his ribs, harder than it had ever beaten in battle, but this wasn't from the fight. It was the rising panic, the growing awareness that he wasn't going to make it. That he was too far gone.

He clenched his fists, feeling the roughness of the dirt beneath his fingertips. No. Not like this. He couldn't let it end this way—on the cold ground, alone, betrayed. The thought of Mydei, of Okhema, of everything he had worked for— it was slipping through his fingers like sand.

His throat constricted, his chest tight with the pressure building inside him. He could feel his breath quickening, shallow and ragged, unable to fill his lungs properly. Focus. Focus. He gritted his teeth, forcing his mind back to the task at hand, but the fear—no, the panic—ripped at him.

What if it's too late? What if I don't make it?

The thought, so foreign to him in his entire life, felt like a vice around his chest. Phainon had never feared death—not like this. He had fought countless battles, stood tall in the face of unimaginable odds, but this… this was different. This wasn't about glory. This wasn't about survival. This was the bitter knowledge that he was powerless, that his strength had failed him.

Phainon's eyes flickered shut for a moment, the world around him dimming as his heartbeat echoed in his ears. *Calm down*. He couldn't let it happen. He couldn't allow himself to fall apart. But the tightness in his chest, the constriction in his throat, the cold sweat that dripped down his brow—it all seemed to be too much.

A choking gasp escaped his lips, his body trembling as he fought to steady himself. He pressed his hand to his chest, desperate to ground himself, to remind himself that he had been through worse, that he had survived more, and this wasn't the end. It can't be.

His thoughts were clouded, his vision wavering. The panic surged, sharp and sudden, a wave crashing over him that he couldn't control. He gasped for air, the very air in his lungs turning into something solid, something suffocating. It was like drowning in the depths of his own mind.

"Stay calm," he muttered, his voice barely audible as he forced himself to sit up, the pressure in his chest nearly unbearable. "Stay calm… Stay *alive*."

But the world refused to stop spinning. His fingers trembled as they dug into the earth beneath him. He forced his eyes open, the effort feeling like a monumental task. The panic clawed at him, suffocating him, telling him that this was it—that this was how his story would end.

The thought of Okhema, the city that had always seemed so far out of reach, felt more like a cruel mirage than a destination now. The trust he had placed in that journey, in himself, was now in question. *Had he been a fool*? Had all of this been for nothing?

His breath came in short, sharp bursts, his body betraying him with every second that ticked by. He squeezed his eyes shut again, fighting the rising tide of panic that threatened to overtake him, to drown him in his own weakness. *Get a grip, Phainon.*

He had always been the one others leaned on. The protector, the strong one. The Deliverer. But now… Now, he was just a man, a man who had trusted the wrong person and was paying the price.

For a moment, he thought about the person he was guiding—about their smile, so cold, so devoid of any remorse. He had felt the first pang of betrayal when the blade sank into his side, but it wasn't until now, as the poison pulsed through him, that he realized just how much that moment had

shattered him. *How had he missed it? How had he been so blind?* It was so obvious from the beginning.

The panic surged again, stronger this time, and Phainon's mind began to fracture. It's too much. The cold, the pain, the betrayal—all of it was crushing him under a weight too heavy to bear. But he had to hold on. He had to make it to Okhema. He had to finish this.

With a strangled breath, Phainon forced himself to rise, his body shaking with the effort. His knees buckled once, then again, but he forced himself to stand, even if it meant dragging himself across the ground inch by inch. The journey wasn't over. It couldn't be over.

Phainon's chest heaved, his breath ragged and shallow. The poison burned through him, eating away at his strength, numbing his body, his mind. He could barely feel his limbs, but he knew he had to keep moving. He had to get up. *He had to make it*.

His vision swam in and out of focus as he tried to push himself to his feet, but the ground seemed to tilt beneath him. His legs gave out, and he collapsed, the earth cool and unforgiving against his face. For a moment, he lay there, feeling the weight of it all—the defeat, the failure, the betrayal. *Was this it*?

The thought lingered in his mind for a second before he shoved it away. No. He wasn't done yet. He wouldn't be.

With a grunt, Phainon pushed against the ground, his fingers trembling as they scraped the dirt. His body screamed in protest, but he forced himself to rise again, his vision blurry, his mind numb. *One more time.*

But as soon as he was upright, he felt the world collapse around him. His legs buckled under his own weight, and he crumpled once more to the cold ground. The panic began to creep up, but Phainon shoved it down. He couldn't—he couldn't let himself give in.

But he was so tired. *So tired.*

Every movement felt like it took all of his remaining strength. His arms were heavy, his chest constricting with each breath. His vision blurred again, the edges of the world darkening. For the first time, he realized it wasn't just the poison that was draining him—it was the sense of *futility* . The more he tried to stand, the harder it became. Each failed attempt felt like a personal betrayal by his own body.

His hand reached out once more, fingers grazing the ground as he tried again to pull himself to his feet, but the numbness in his mind began to take hold. The weight of his failure pressed against him, heavier than the poison.

What's the point?

His thoughts were foggy, distant. *I'm too far gone*. He couldn't make it. The pain was too much. The poison too strong. The betrayal, the isolation, the helplessness—it was all too much to bear.

His breath caught in his throat, his head sinking against the ground. He no longer had the energy to even try. His mind went numb, everything slipping away in waves. The thought of Okhema—of everything he had fought for—felt so distant, like a dream he couldn't reach. *I failed.*

The numbness spread, pulling him into a dark, empty place where nothing mattered anymore. His thoughts slowed, his body freezing in place. He couldn't fight anymore. *Let it end.*

Then—

A crack. A shift in the air. The sound of footsteps—faint, but distinct.

Phainon's eyelids fluttered open, but the world around him was still spinning. The poison clouded his senses, but something—someone—was near. He wasn't sure if he was hallucinating, but the sound, the presence, felt too real to be anything but.

"Mydei?"

The name slipped from his lips, weak and unsure. It was the one thing he could grasp, the one thing that still felt like a lifeline. But he wasn't sure if it was a dream.

The figure standing before him wasn't clear at first. The edges of the world still danced in and out of focus, but the shape of the man—dark, tall, unwavering—cut through the haze. It was him. Mydei.

The words caught in Phainon's throat. His vision blurred again, the nausea rising, but then Mydei's voice—sharp, familiar—broke through the fog.

"Get up."

It wasn't a plea. It wasn't soft. It wasn't comforting. It was a command. And it was just enough to pierce through Phainon's numbness.

His body shook as he tried to sit up, but his limbs wouldn't obey him. He was dead weight, his muscles refusing to move. But Mydei… Mydei's presence was enough to keep him grounded, even as the poison ate at his insides, stripping him of his strength.

Phainon tried again, struggling to find purchase on the earth beneath him, but his vision swam, the world tilting as he fell back. He couldn't fight it anymore—he couldn't get up. He felt the cold creeping in, and his mind grew quieter with each passing second.

Mydei didn't move. He didn't rush to Phainon's side. He remained where he stood, eerily calm—silent, still. His gaze was steady, unwavering, as if the chaos of the situation didn't touch him at all. There was no anger in his expression, no frustration, just the same unreadable calm Phainon had seen in him before. But this time, it was different. It wasn't the usual coldness. It was something far more unsettling.

"Who did this to you?"

The words, though spoken softly, felt like a blow. Mydei's voice was calm, but there was a depth to it that Phainon wasn't used to hearing. He couldn't

place it. Mydei wasn’t angry. He wasn’t frantic. He wasn’t even bitter. He was simply… *there* .

Phainon swallowed, the words on the tip of his tongue, but they wouldn’t come. His chest was tight, his throat constricted from the poison and the sudden weight of Mydei’s gaze. He couldn’t bring himself to speak, and he couldn’t meet Mydei’s eyes. But he could feel the weight of the question hanging in the air. It felt heavier than the poison, heavier than the entire world crashing down around him.

“Who?” Mydei repeated, his tone still soft, his voice almost… gentle.

Phainon couldn’t answer. His mind was sluggish, barely keeping up with the conversation. He tried to speak, but his breath came in shallow bursts, his chest tightening with every inhale. His head swam, and he could feel the darkness pulling at the edges of his consciousness.

But Mydei didn’t push. He didn’t demand. He simply watched, his eyes soft in a way that Phainon had never seen before.

For a brief moment, Phainon saw the cracks in Mydei’s usual demeanor—softness , not anger, not detachment. Just… care. But it didn’t make sense. Not with how things just went.

Phainon tried to shake his head, but the weight of his own body was too much. His eyes fluttered, the darkness closing in. No. Not yet. Not like this.

“Stay awake,” Mydei’s voice commanded, gentle yet firm, as if it was a simple request. Phainon could feel his hand gripping his arm, pulling him up slightly, but his body refused to cooperate.

Phainon couldn’t do it. His eyes closed, the world slipping away, and the last thing he heard before everything went dark was Mydei’s voice, softer now, tinged with something that made Phainon’s heart ache—something Phainon couldn’t identify.

“You’ll make it.”

Phainon’s legs gave way beneath him, his body no longer able to hold itself upright. The world spun, and before he could brace himself, Mydei was there, steadying him with a firm grip.

Without hesitation, Mydei pulled Phainon closer, supporting him with ease as his breath came in sharp, labored gasps. Mydei’s presence was grounding, his quiet calm a stark contrast to the chaos swirling around them. He didn’t need to say anything. The silence between them was enough.

Phainon didn’t speak. His fingers gripped Mydei tightly, his body trembling with exhaustion. He couldn’t summon the strength to form words, but Mydei didn’t need him to. There was no anger, no impatience in Mydei’s actions—just the steady assurance of his touch.

Mydei didn’t look down at him. His focus remained ahead, steady and unwavering, as if he understood without needing to ask what Phainon needed. Mydei was simply there, offering what little stability Phainon could cling to in that moment.

For a long while, they stood together. Phainon leaned against Mydei, not needing anything more than the quiet reassurance that he wasn’t alone. His breathing slowed, the panicked flutter of his chest finally easing, though his mind remained clouded by the poison. Mydei’s presence, unwavering and silent, allowed him to let go.

Phainon’s grip on Mydei loosened as his body finally gave in. His head fell to rest lightly against Mydei’s shoulder, his breath steadying. The pressure in his chest released as he drifted into unconsciousness, the world fading away.

Phainon’s eyes slowly cracked open, his body heavy, weighed down by the exhaustion and pain that had followed him through the fog of unconsciousness. His side throbbed with the dull ache of fresh bandages, and his chest felt tight, though not from the poison anymore. It was something else—something much quieter, almost like the weight of the world pressing down on him, holding him in place.

He blinked, trying to focus on the room around him. The ceiling above him was unfamiliar, the stone walls of Okhema too clean, too… new. The gentle scent of healing herbs hung in the air, and the soft murmur of distant voices floated in from somewhere outside the room. The rhythmic click of boots echoed faintly along the stone hallways.

And then, he noticed her. Tribbie sat beside him, her usual energy replaced by something more subdued. Her eyes were fixed on him, her brow furrowed in concern, though she didn't speak immediately. It was as if she were waiting for him to acknowledge her first.

Phainon cleared his throat, the rasp in his voice a painful reminder of how much he'd been through. His voice cracked as he spoke, but it was enough for Tribbie to hear. "Where…?"

"You're in Okhema," Tribbie replied, her tone softer than usual, but still tinged with that edge of worry. "You've been out for a while."

Phainon tried to sit up, but his body refused to cooperate, pain surging through him like a bolt of electricity. He winced, but Tribbie was quick to steady him, her hands firm but gentle against his shoulders.

"Easy Snowy," she said, her voice just shy of a command. "Don't push it. You've been through a lot."

Phainon swallowed, his eyes flickering to the bandages on his side. The memories came rushing back—barely escaping, fighting off the poison, the betrayal. His mind felt like it was still struggling to piece everything together. He shifted slightly, trying to find some form of balance in his exhausted state, before his gaze finally landed on her again.

"Mydei…" His voice was hoarse, almost a whisper, but there was a sharpness in the way he said the name, as if he couldn't rest until he knew.

Tribbie paused, her expression unreadable for a moment. Then, with a sigh, she answered, "He carried you all the way here… without a word." Her eyes softened, but the weariness in her gaze suggested more than just the physical exhaustion of the journey. "He didn't seem fine, Phainon. Calmer

than usual, even… But there was something else about him, something that kept everyone here from talking. It was like…" She trailed off, unsure of how to explain it.

Phainon's brow furrowed, and he tried to sit up again, this time with more effort, pushing through the lingering fog in his mind. "What do you mean?"

Tribbie's eyes flicked toward the door briefly, her voice dropping lower as she spoke. "He was… different. More than usual. His presence, Phainon—it wasn't just calm. It was threatening. Even the citizens of Okhema—who gossip about everything—kept their mouths shut. Nobody dared to say a word about what happened."

Phainon's mind spun at the revelation. Mydei, usually so stoic, so unflappable—had he really been different? Had it been that bad? He felt the pull of those questions in his chest, but his body felt too heavy to pursue them any further. He closed his eyes again, trying to center himself.

But just as the exhaustion began to settle in, Tribbie suddenly stiffened. Her gaze flickered toward the door, her eyes narrowing slightly as she noticed a figure standing there.

Phainon followed her gaze, but before he could fully comprehend the presence, the figure stepped forward silently, their steps almost imperceptible on the stone floor. The person leaned toward Tribbie, and though they didn't speak loudly, Phainon caught the soft murmur of their voice.

"I'll keep it brief," the figure whispered, barely audible over the sound of Phainon's own breathing.

Tribbie's face tightened slightly, and she gave a subtle nod, her eyes flashing with a flicker of something unspoken. The whisper seemed to make her pause, and Phainon watched as her expression shifted, something changing in her eyes that he couldn't quite place.

Phainon, still struggling to make sense of everything, tried to speak, but his voice came out barely above a whisper. "What was that?"

Tribbie turned back to him, giving him a reassuring smile, but there was something guarded in her expression now. “Nothing, just… someone whispered something to me.” Her voice dropped a little lower. “**We’ll** tell you later, alright? Just rest for now.”

Phainon didn’t push, though his curiosity was piqued. He nodded, the confusion swirling in his mind, but the weariness pulling him back into the quiet haze. His eyelids grew heavy again, and the weight of it all seemed to pull him down into sleep, though the echo of that whisper stayed with him.

After he’d woken up again, he’d pestered Tribbie for what seemed like hours till she finally told him what happened.

Tribbie’s gaze softened, but her voice remained even, almost detached as she continued. “After Mydei had left, he went after everyone in the group. They were known as the Followers of Salvation, a newly formed organization who’ve been frequently causing trouble, believing in the complete eradication of the Chrysos heirs and absolute monarchy of the Titans. **We** didn’t expect it to happen—didn’t think he’d move so quickly, but it seems he’s… succeeded.”

She shifted slightly in her seat, her hands clasped in front of her as she watched Phainon closely. “All of them. In a day. No survivors. It wasn’t a fight; it was just… done. No time for them to regroup, no room to escape. Mydei didn’t give them that chance.”

Phainon’s chest tightened as the thought settled in. An entire group—one that had been targeting him, his blood still fresh in the air—gone, erased in a single sweep. He felt disturbed by it. How could Mydei do something like that? Was it the right choice? Was it necessary?

But in the pit of his stomach, a different feeling stirred, one that he couldn’t quite explain. The warmth that spread through him was unsettling—sickening, almost. Mydei had taken everything from them. Every last person who had hurt him.

Phainon couldn’t help but feel a strange satisfaction at that. No mercy. No hesitation. They deserved it. And yet, even now, knowing how extreme Mydei’s response had been, Phainon couldn’t shake that feeling. It felt… right.

He looked down at his hands, half in disbelief. Was he really thinking this? Part of him wanted to condemn the violence. But another part of him couldn’t help but feel relief, warmth, like someone had finally taken the burden off his shoulders. Mydei had done it for him, in a way no one else could.

“**We** didn’t think he’d go this far,” Tribbie added, breaking through his thoughts. “But it’s done. And now… **We** don’t know what’s next.”

Phainon leaned back into the pillows, letting the silence settle between them. He wasn’t sure what was next either. His body still ached, but the emotional weight—of the betrayal, the pain, and now the strange comfort of Mydei’s actions—was harder to shake.

In the end, Phainon couldn’t shake the reality of Mydei’s actions. There had been no mercy, no second thoughts, just the swift execution of a threat. It wasn’t what Phainon had expected, but it was what had happened. Despite the violence, despite the methodical way Mydei had wiped them out, part of Phainon found it strangely… reassuring. Mydei’s relentless drive to eliminate any threat, even if it was a brutal overstep, gave Phainon an odd sense of security. He didn’t know if he should be grateful or disturbed by it, but he couldn’t ignore the fact that Mydei had handled it—had handled it all—for him.

He wondered when Mydei would return, a warmth unfurling in his chest, unexpected but undeniable. It was a strange feeling, but somehow it was comforting. As the minutes passed, the weight of everything else began to fade, and Phainon found himself waiting—not just for Mydei’s return, but for the sense of something more he couldn’t yet name. The thought lingered with him as the world outside grew still, and he allowed himself to rest, the promise of Mydei’s presence more than enough to carry him through.

End Notes

I’m a bit disappointed with this as I feel I didn’t do the trope justice, or Mydei and Phainon’s dynamic as well as Tribbie’s character.

The ending was a bit rushed, but please bear with me. I was hunched for an hour straight, my mind not working as I wrote this down with my grimy hands on the notes app on my phone.

Any criticism as long as it’s constructive is ALWAYS, and I mean ALWAYS appreciated. If there are anyways I can improve this fic please tell me because I’m 50% sure I’m gonna basically do the same scenario but with Mydei injured, so might as well improve on that.

Once again, thanks for reading <33

PS, if any of you have Myphai/Phaidei fanfic ideas, please tell me so when I have free time I can write it😊

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!